

Time Tracker

User Manual

App version 0.28.0 · July 2026

Welcome! This guide explains everything you can do in the Sabeel Institute Time Tracker — from logging your first hour to approving your team's timesheets. It is organized by role: **everyone** starts with Part 1; **managers/approvers** add Part 2; **admins** add Part 3. Part 4 is a quick "How do I…?" index you can skim any time.

The app works the same on the website (https://sabeel-institute-time-tracker.web.app), the Android app and the iPhone app — same account, same data, live everywhere.

Getting the phone app. Android: the download page (https://faisal-shah.github.io/sabeel-time-tracker/), or Google Play by invitation from your administrator. iPhone: TestFlight, by invitation from your administrator. If your Android phone has the app from the download page older than version 0.28.0, uninstall it once before installing a newer one; nothing is lost, because everything is kept online.

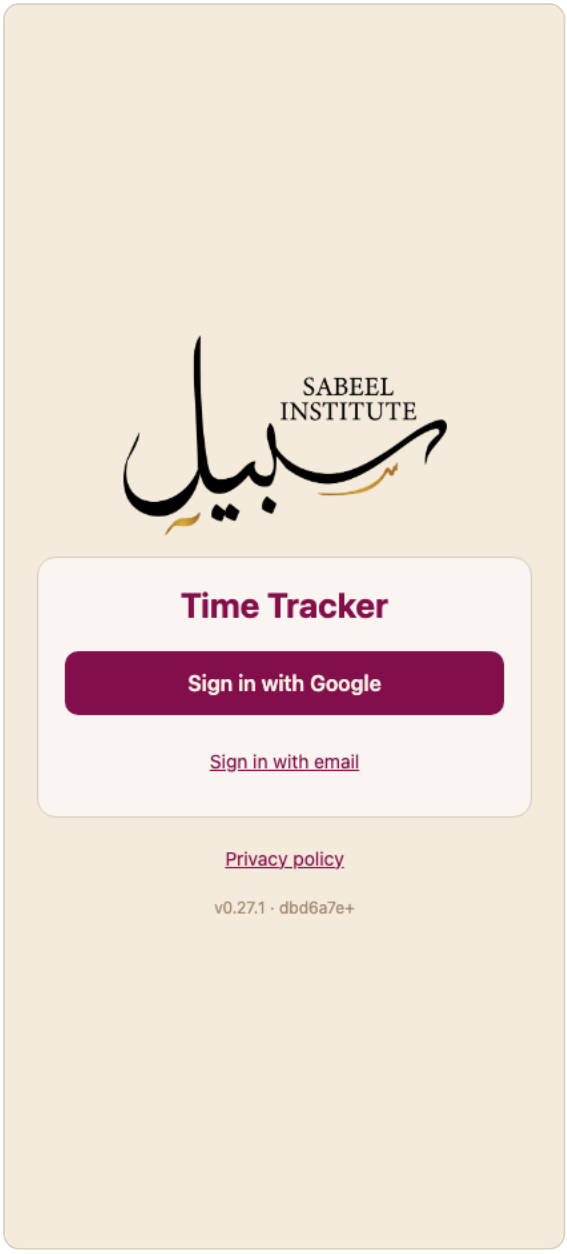
The big picture (2 minutes)

1. **You log hours** against an *activity* — either by clocking in and out while you work, or by adding hours manually afterwards. Every hour belongs to a **week** (Sunday to Saturday, never crossing a month boundary — so the first or last week of a month can be short).
2. **At the end of the week you submit a timesheet.** That freezes the week and sends it to your **approver** — a manager you pick once, in the app.
3. **Your approver approves it** (it becomes official and counts in reports) or **rejects it with a reason** (it comes back to you to fix and resubmit).
4. **Official reports count approved timesheets only.** Until a week is approved, its hours exist but aren't part of the official record.

That's the whole system. Everything below is detail.

Part 1 — For everyone

1.1 Signing in



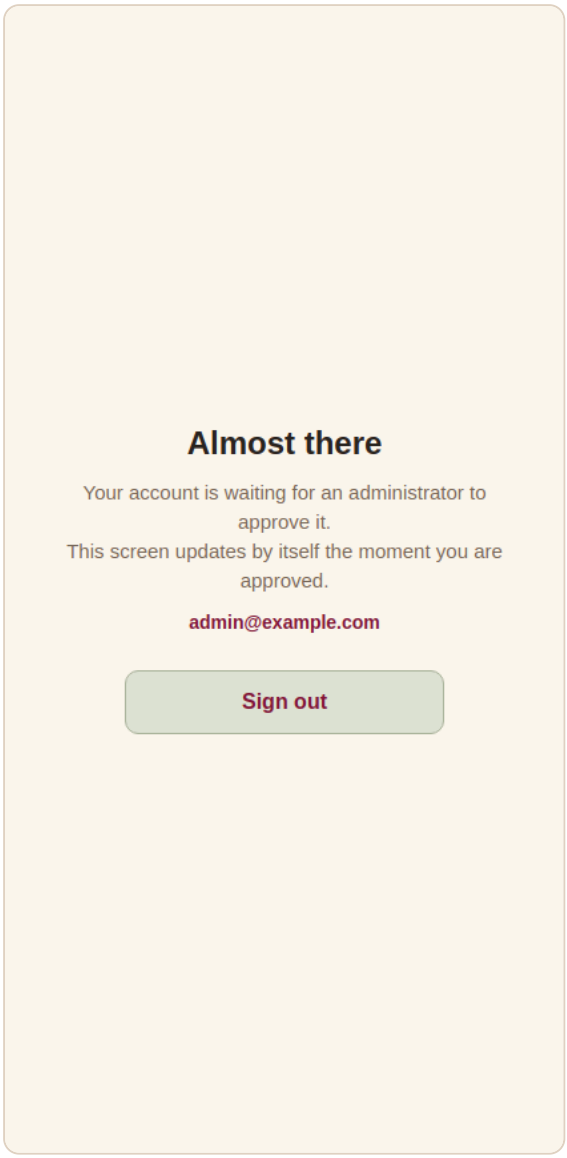
Open the app or website and tap **Sign in with Google**. Google's account chooser appears — pick your account (or "Use another account" to switch). There are no passwords to remember; access is entirely through your Google account. (**Sign in with email**, under the Google button, is not for staff accounts: always use Google.)

The very first time, sign in on the website (https://sabeel-institute-time-tracker.web.app) with your `@oursabeel.com` account. That is what creates your account. The phone apps only sign in accounts that already exist: until you have signed in on the website once, they say *"This account*

isn’t set up for the app yet. Contact your administrator.”

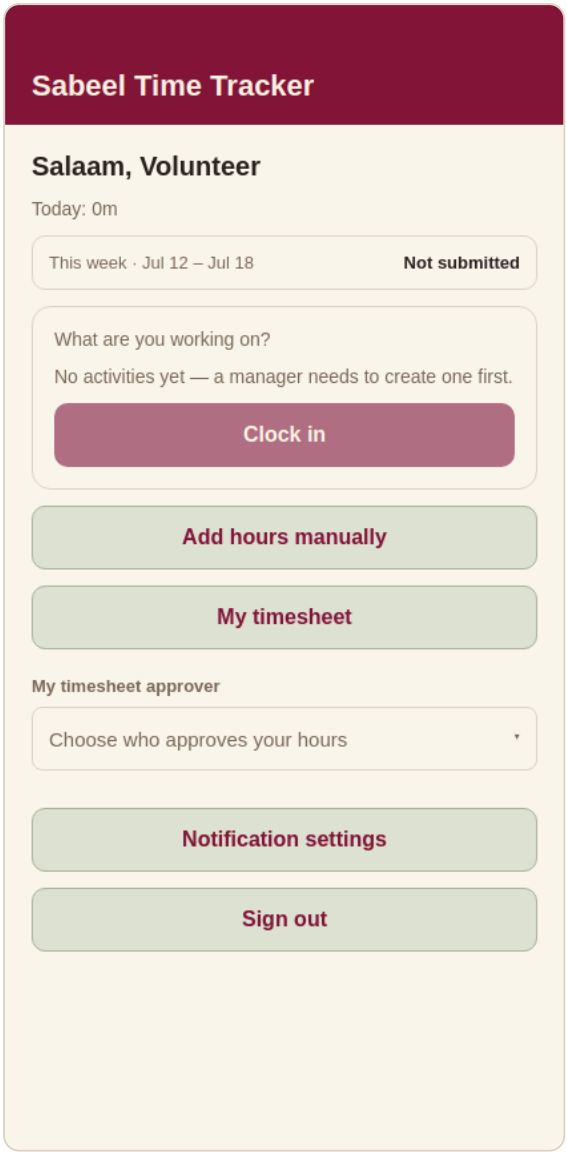
The **Privacy policy** link under the sign-in card (and at the bottom of Home) says what the app stores and how to ask for your account to be deleted.

First time? You’ll wait for approval



New accounts land on an **“Almost there”** screen. An administrator has to approve your account before you can use the app — this screen updates by itself the moment they do, no refresh needed. If you seem stuck here, contact your admin.

1.2 Your home screen



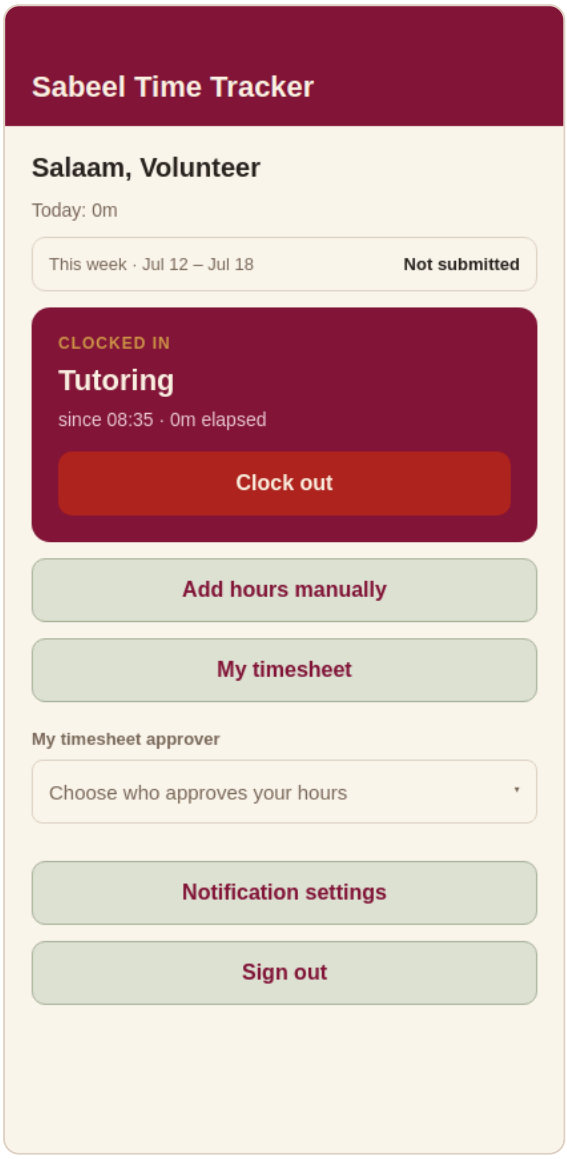
From top to bottom:

- **Today's total** — hours logged so far today.
- **This week strip** — the current week's dates and its timesheet status (*Not submitted*, *Awaiting approval*, *Approved*, or *Rejected*). Tap it to open the week.
- **Clock in card** — pick what you're working on and clock in.
- **Add hours manually / My timesheet** — the other two things you'll use daily.
- **My timesheet approver** — who approves your weeks (see 1.5).
- **Notification settings** — choose which push notifications you get (see 1.9).
- If a timesheet of yours was rejected, a **red banner** appears at the very top — tap it to fix things (see 1.7).

Managers and admins see extra buttons here (Approvals, Reports, Activities, Manage users) — covered in Parts 2 and 3.

1.3 Logging hours

Clocking in and out (live tracking)



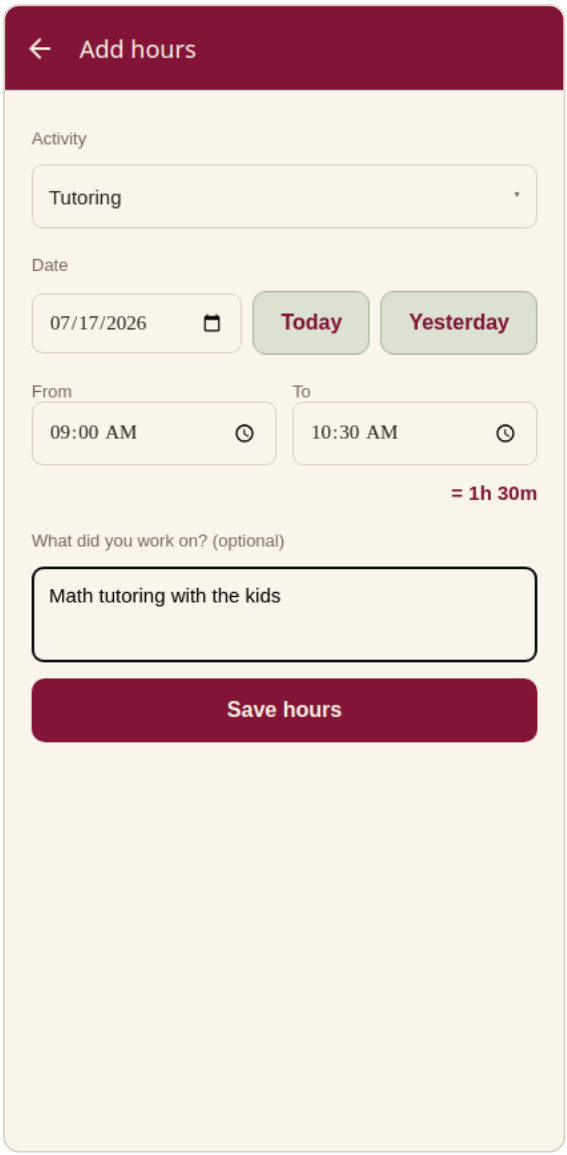
1. On Home, tap **Pick an activity**, search or scroll, tap one.
2. Tap **Clock in**. The raspberry card shows what you're working on and a running clock.
3. When you finish, tap **Clock out**. The session becomes an entry on today's timesheet.

Good to know:

- You can only have **one running session** at a time.

- Forgot to clock out? Sessions are **automatically closed after 12 hours** and marked “auto-closed” — edit the entry afterwards to correct the times.
- The app reminds you on-screen once a session passes 8 hours.

Adding hours manually



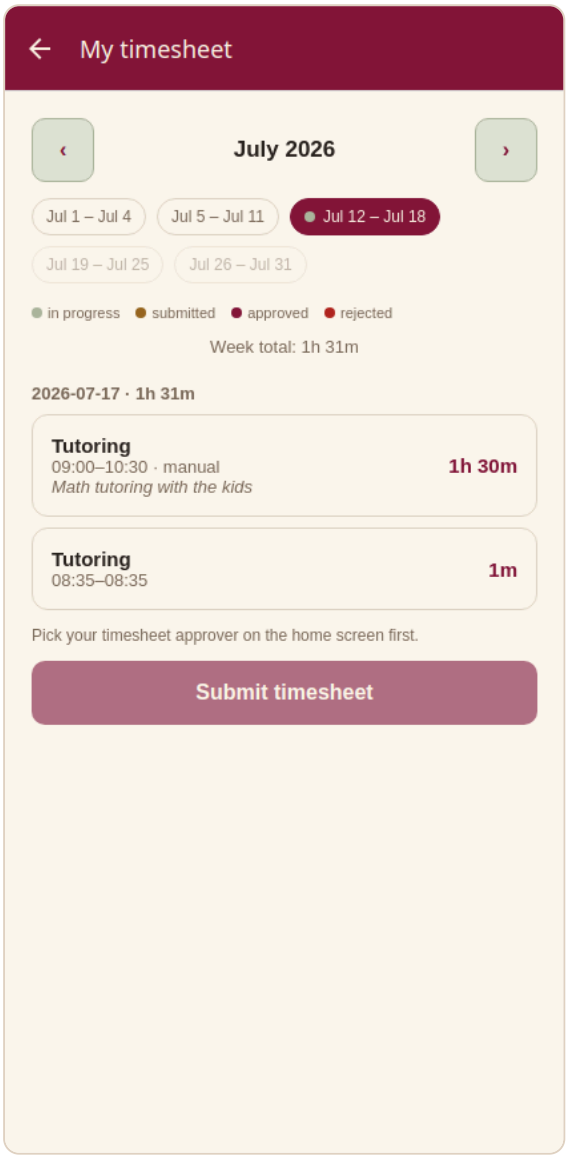
For work you didn’t clock (yesterday’s event, off-site work):

1. Home → **Add hours manually**.
2. Pick the activity, the date (**Today** / **Yesterday** shortcuts, or the date picker), and the from/to times with the time pickers.
3. Watch the **”= 8h 00m”** line under the times — it shows the duration you’re about to save, so AM/PM mistakes jump out before you save.
4. Optionally describe what you did, then **Save hours**.

Copying last week

If your weeks look alike: open an **empty** week in My timesheet and tap **“Copy last week’s hours”**. Every entry from the previous week is copied to the same weekday and time, ready to adjust. (Only offered while the week has no entries yet.)

1.4 Your timesheet week by week

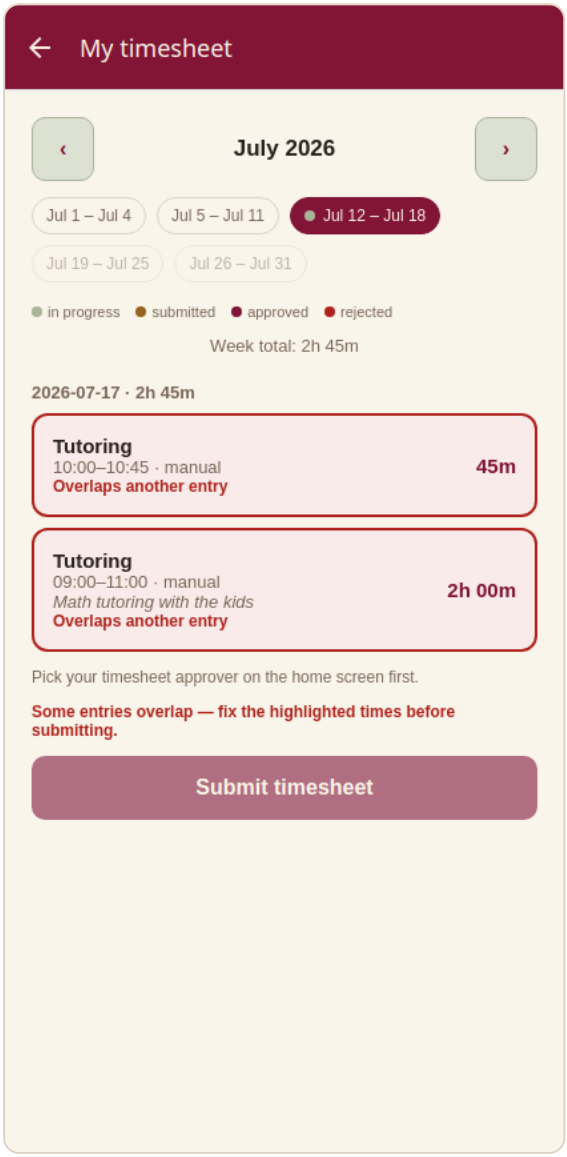


Home → **My timesheet**. What you’re looking at, top to bottom:

- **The month and year**, with **‹ › arrows** that step month by month.
- **Week chips** — one per week of the month; tap a chip to open that week. The colored dots are a status legend (also printed right below the chips):
- **sage/green dot** — hours logged, not submitted yet (work in progress)

- **gold dot** — submitted, awaiting the approver
- **raspberry dot** — approved (final)
- **red dot** — rejected (needs your attention)
- **no dot** — empty week
- **Week total** — the selected week's hours, with its status next to it.
- **Day groups** — each day's entries with times and durations. **Tap an entry to edit or delete it** (activity, date, times, note).
- Future weeks are dimmed — there's nothing to do there yet. Wandered off? **Jump to current week** brings you back.

Overlapping entries



Two entries on the same day whose times overlap are **highlighted in red** (“Overlaps another entry”) — usually a double-log or an AM/PM slip. A week with overlaps **can’t be submitted** until you fix the times (tap an entry to edit it). Back-to-back entries are fine: one ending at 2:00 PM and the next starting at 2:00 PM don’t overlap.

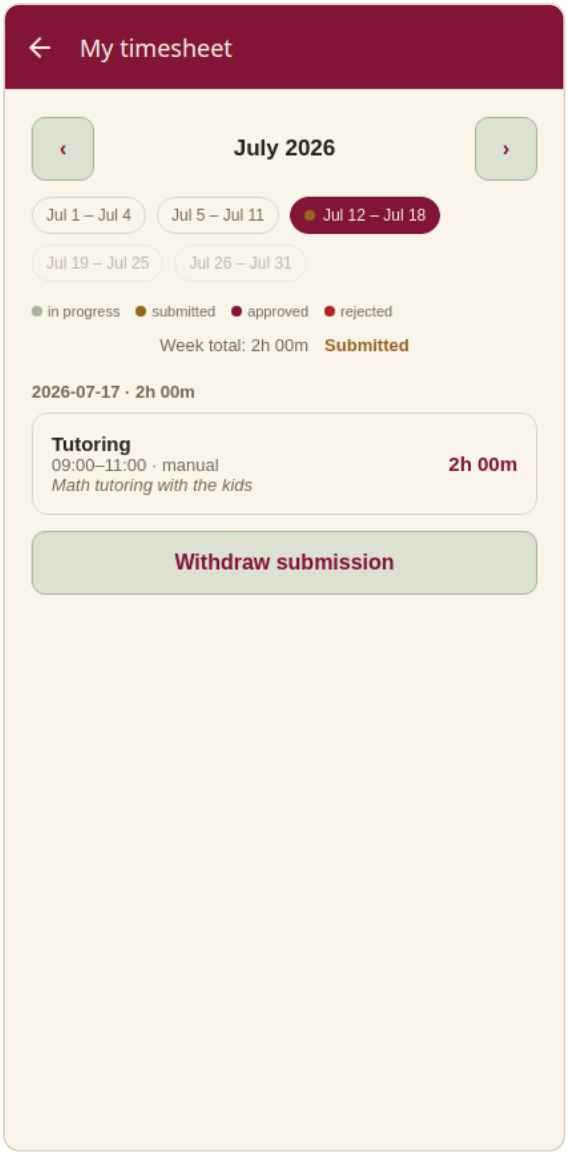
1.5 Picking your approver (one-time setup)

Before your first submission, tell the app who approves your hours: on Home, under **My timesheet approver**, tap the selector and pick from the list of managers. This is sticky — it applies to all future submissions until you change it. Changing it never affects a timesheet you’ve already submitted.

If you are a manager or an admin yourself, your own name appears at the bottom of the list as **“(myself)”** — managers and admins may approve their own hours. Even then you still submit first and approve after: a submitted week is locked to you like anyone else’s, so withdraw it if you need to make a change.

Can’t submit and see “Pick your timesheet approver on the home screen first”? This is why.

1.6 Submitting your week



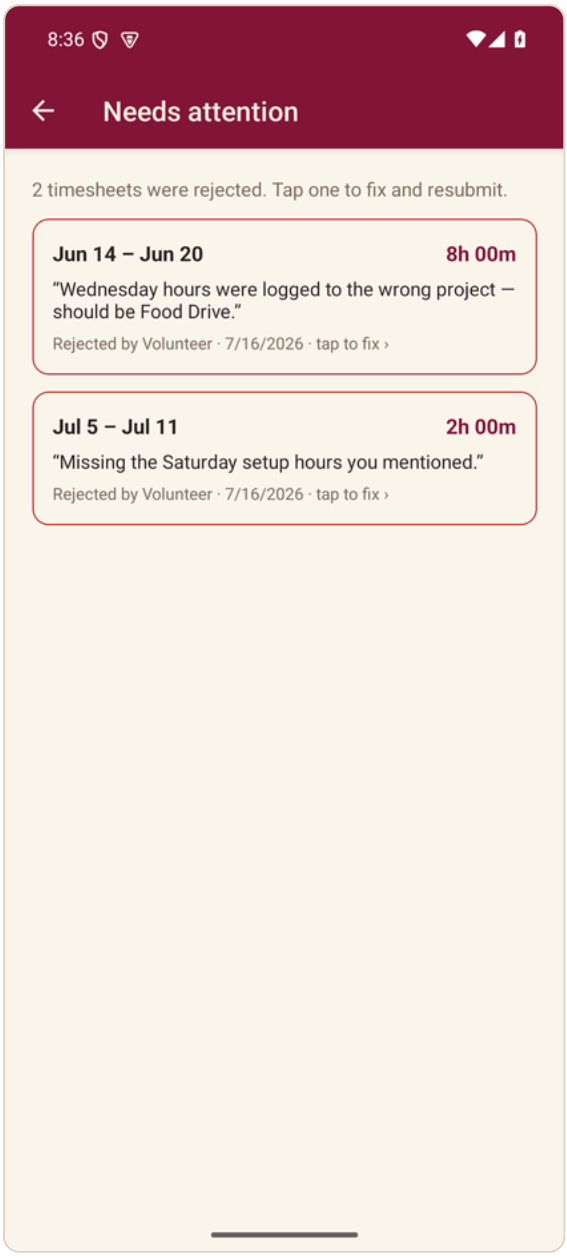
1. Open the week in **My timesheet** and give it a once-over.
2. Tap **Submit timesheet**. The status turns **Submitted** (gold) and the week **locks** — you can't add or edit entries while your approver has it.
3. Change your mind? **Withdraw submission** unlocks it (only until it's approved).

Rules of thumb:

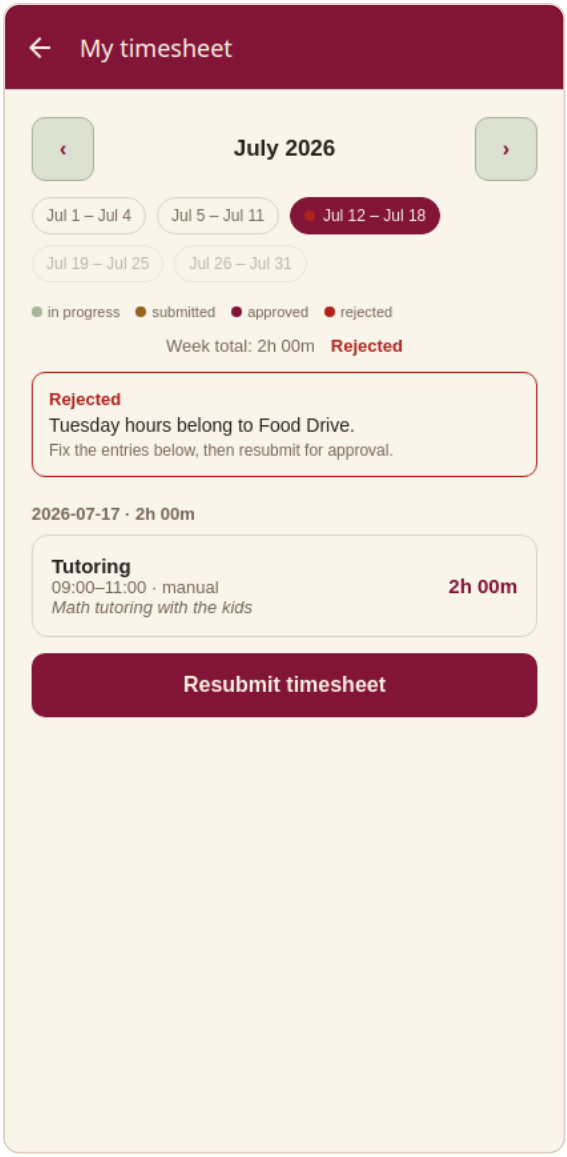
- You can submit the **current week early** (say, Friday) — but you can't log more hours into it afterwards without withdrawing first. If you're clocked in, clock out before submitting.
- **Overlapping entries block submission** (see 1.4) — fix the highlighted times first.
- **Past weeks can be submitted any time, in any order.** No deadlines.

- **Empty weeks can be submitted too** (“Submit timesheet (no hours)”) — useful to close out a week you were away.
- Future weeks can’t be submitted.

1.7 When a timesheet is rejected



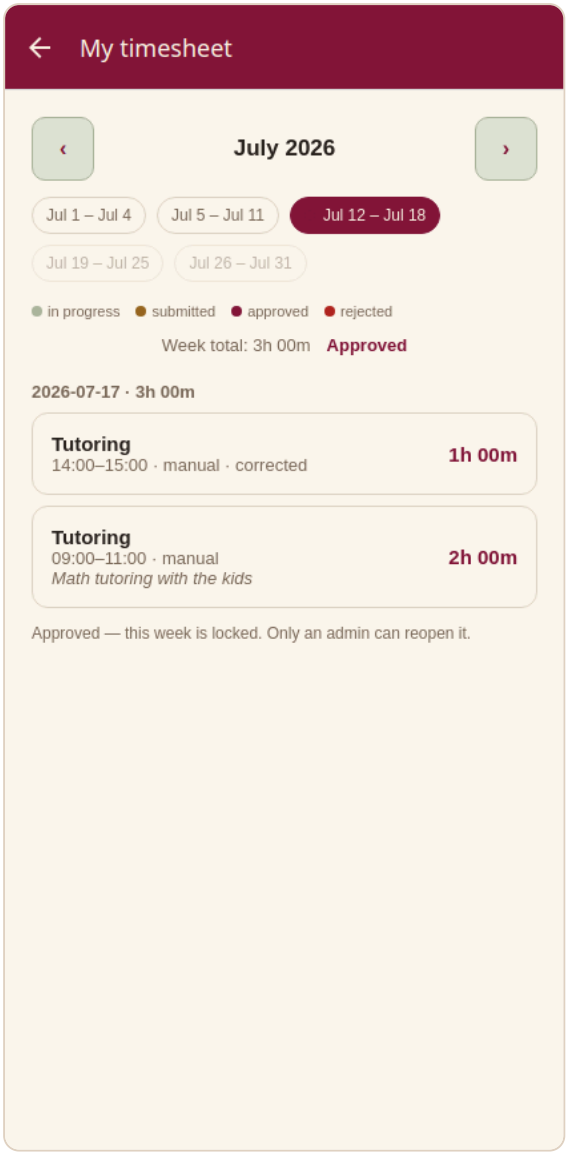
If your approver rejects a week, a **red banner appears on Home**. Tap it to open **Needs attention** — a single list of every rejected week (even from months back), each showing the approver’s reason, who rejected it, and when.



Tap a row and you land on that week, with the reason at the top:

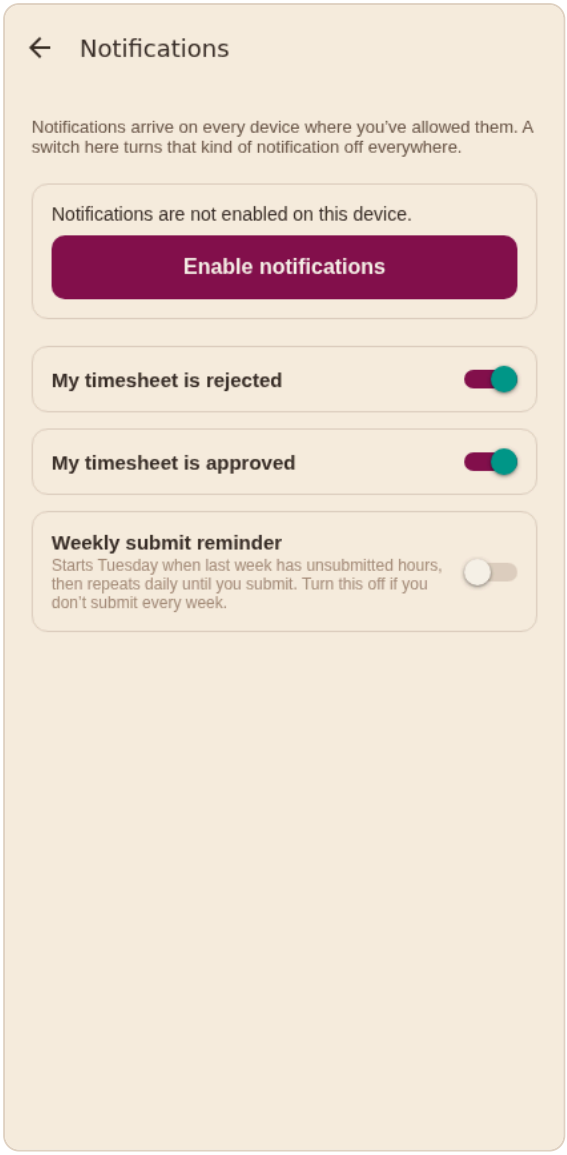
1. Fix the entries the reason points at (tap to edit, add what's missing).
2. Tap **Resubmit timesheet**. It goes back to your approver, and the item disappears from Needs attention.

1.8 After approval



An approved week shows **Approved** and is locked for everyone — that's what makes it official. Spot a mistake after approval? Ask an **admin** to reopen the week; it returns to draft and goes through submit → approve again.

1.9 Notifications



The app sends push notifications so nothing sits unnoticed:

- **Your timesheet was rejected** (with the reason) or **approved**.
- *Approvers:* someone **submitted or resubmitted** a timesheet to you.
- *Admins:* a **new account** is waiting for approval.
- A **submit reminder** — if last week has logged hours that were never submitted (or a rejected sheet), you get a nudge on **Tuesday morning** in your local timezone, and then **daily** until you submit it. Weeks with nothing to submit don't nag.

Tapping a notification opens the screen it is about, not just the app: a decision on your timesheet opens that week; a submission opens that person's week ready to review; a new account request opens the user list. This works from a closed app too — the app finishes signing you in

first, then goes there.

Push notifications need the device's own permission. The app never asks by itself: it offers to set it up once, with an **Enable notifications** card on the Home screen after you sign in — or you can open Home → **Notification settings** any time and use **Enable notifications**. The phone's own question appears only when you tap one of those (on an iPhone it can be asked only once, so answer **Allow**). If they have been blocked, that button becomes **Open settings** on a phone; in a browser, allow them from the site settings behind the icon in the address bar. That screen also lets you switch each kind off individually; the **weekly reminder has its own switch**, so people who don't submit every week can silence the nagging while keeping the important notifications on.

On Android these all arrive under one entry in the phone's own notification settings — **Timesheet alerts and reminders**. Turning that entry off silences every kind at once, whatever the switches inside the app say.

Notifications follow the account signed in on the device: signing out stops this phone or browser from receiving that account's notifications.

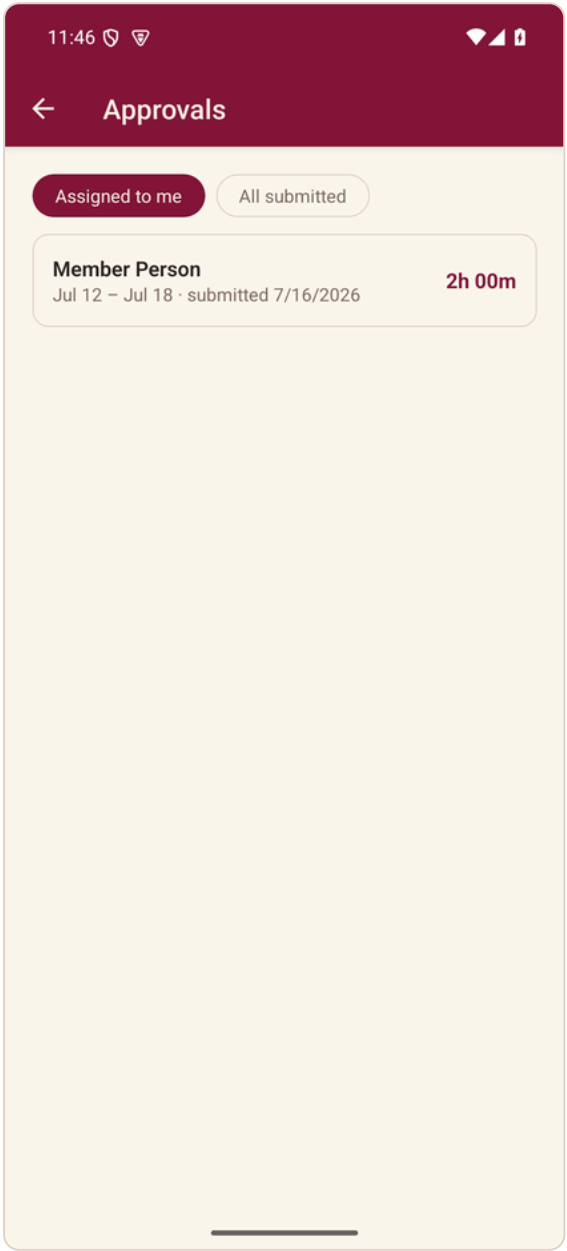
1.10 Switching accounts / signing out

Sign out is at the bottom of Home. Signing out fully clears your Google session in the app, so the next sign-in always shows Google's account chooser — that's how you switch between accounts.

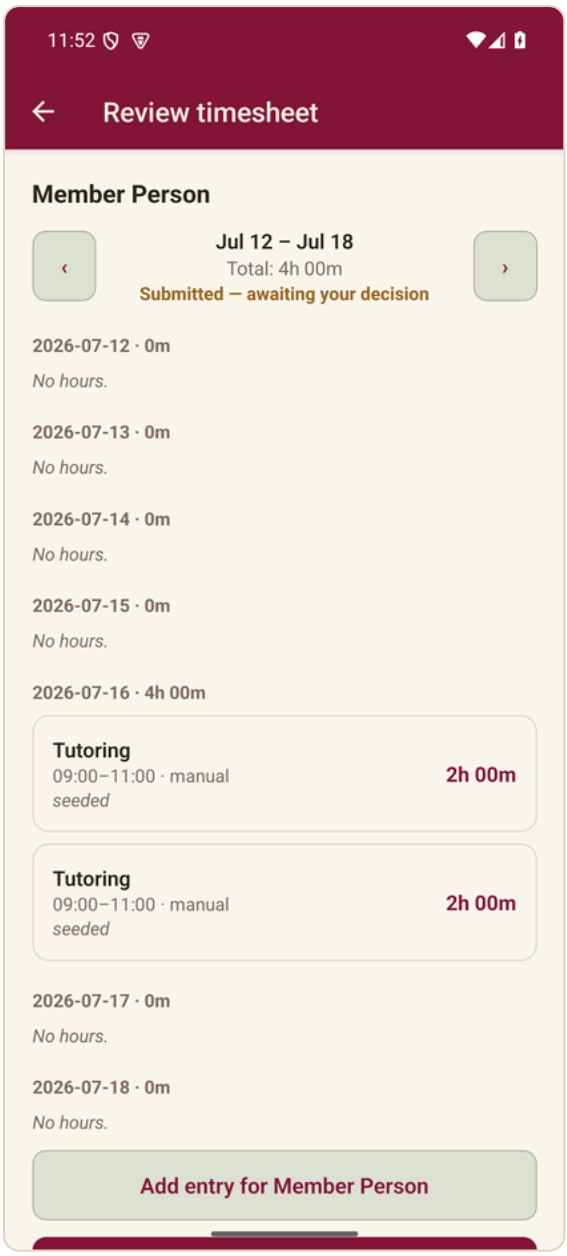
Part 2 — For managers & approvers

Managers see three extra buttons on Home — **Approvals**, **Reports**, and **Activities** — plus **Manage users** (approver assignment).

2.1 Approving timesheets



Home → **Approvals**. The badge on the button shows how many submissions are waiting for *you* (you see the sheets whose submitters picked you as their approver; admins also get an “All submitted” toggle to see everyone’s queue).



Tap a submission to review it:

- Every day of the week is laid out Sunday → Saturday, including empty days — so missing days are as visible as logged ones.
- **Tap any entry to correct it** (times, activity, note) — your edit is flagged "corrected" on the entry.
- **Add entry for {name}** logs hours on the person's behalf (e.g. they forgot their Saturday setup hours). **Times are read in *their* timezone, not yours** — enter the hours as that person worked them, and if their zone differs from yours the screen says so under their name. That way an entry always means what the person actually did, whoever typed it in.
- Then either:
- **Approve timesheet** — the week becomes official and locks, or

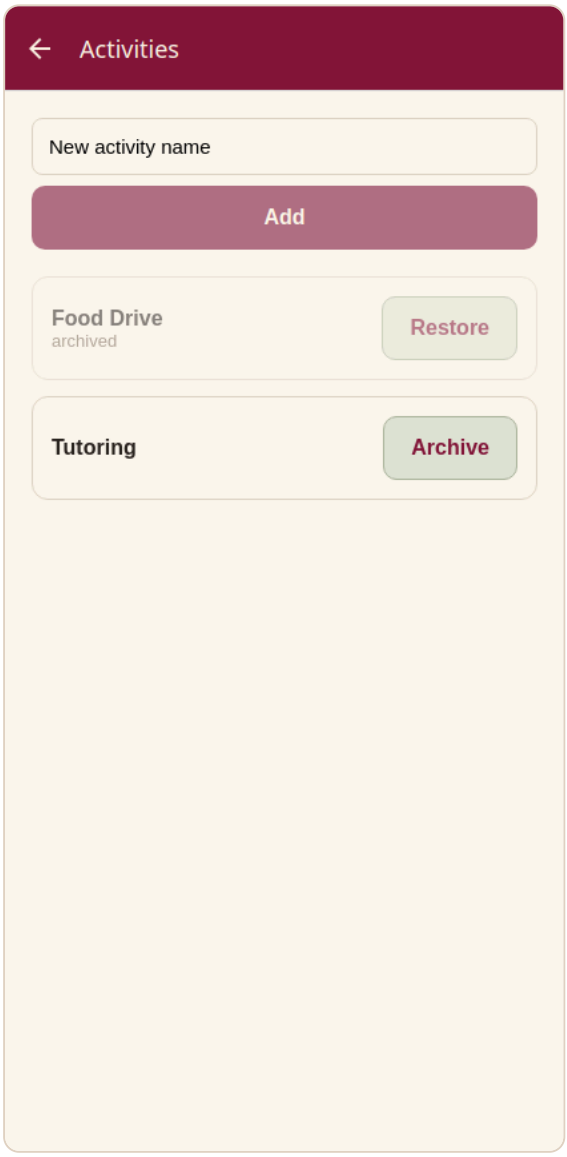
- type a reason and **Reject timesheet** — it returns to the owner, who sees your reason word for word. A reason is required; “fix it” helps nobody.

Use the **‹ › arrows** on this screen to step through the person’s other weeks — you can review or correct any non-approved week, not just the submitted one.

2.2 Browsing someone’s timesheets (before they submit)

Reports → tap a person in the **By person** list → **View timesheets**. Same week-by-week view as above — handy mid-week to see how someone’s week is shaping up, or to add hours they forgot, without waiting for a submission.

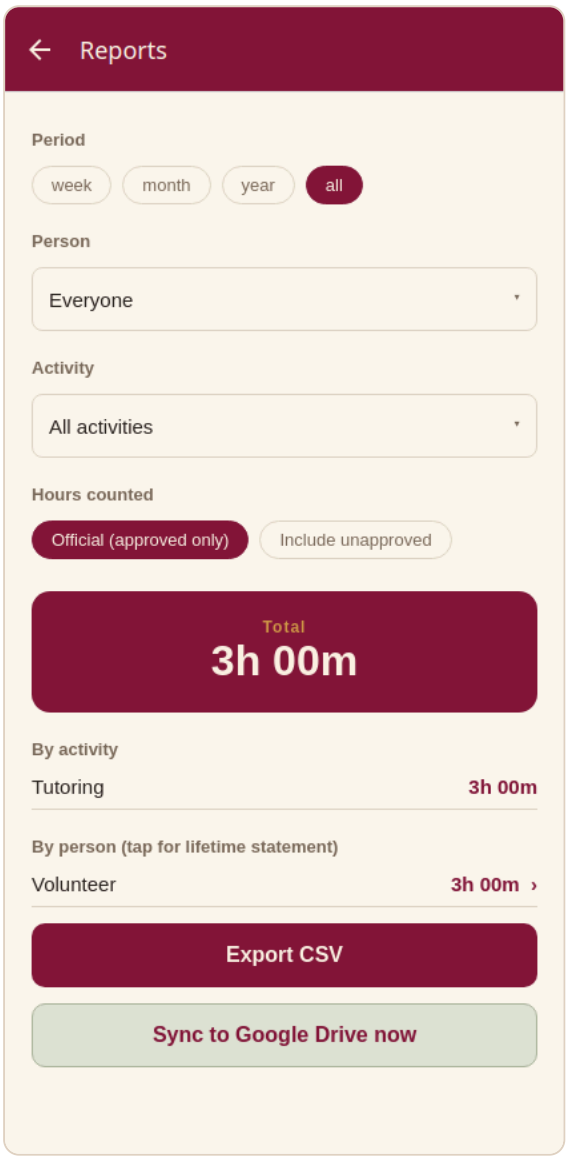
2.3 Activities



Home → **Activities**. Create the activities people log hours against — a name is all it takes, whether it's an ongoing program ("Tutoring") or a one-off event ("Food Drive").

Activities are never deleted — **archive** them instead. Archived activities disappear from pickers but keep their history in every report. **Restore** brings one back.

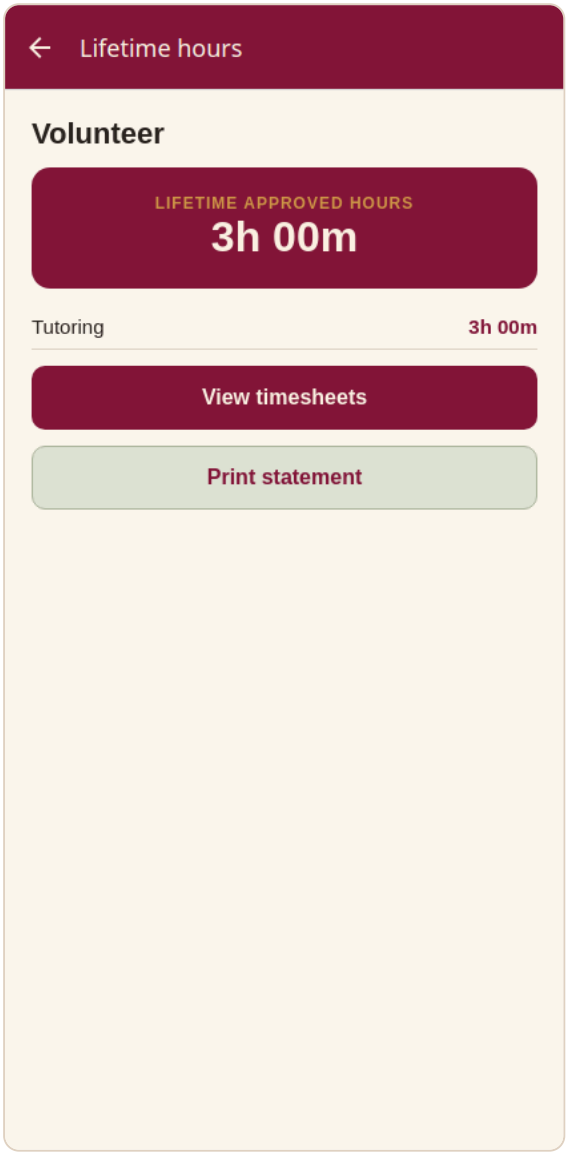
2.4 Reports & exports



Home → **Reports**:

- **Period** — this week / this month / this year / all time.
- **Person / Activity** — searchable filters; default is everyone/everything.
- **Hours counted** — the important switch:

- **Official (approved only)** — the default. Only hours from *approved* timesheets. This is the number for the board, grants, and records.
- **Include unapproved** — adds hours still awaiting approval (marked unofficial; CSV exports get an `_unofficial` filename so nobody mistakes them).
- **Export CSV** — downloads the filtered entries with person, email, activity, date, times, timezone, and hours per row.



Tapping a person shows their lifetime approved hours by activity, plus **Print statement** (on the website) — a clean printable statement of their volunteer hours, e.g. for school credit letters.

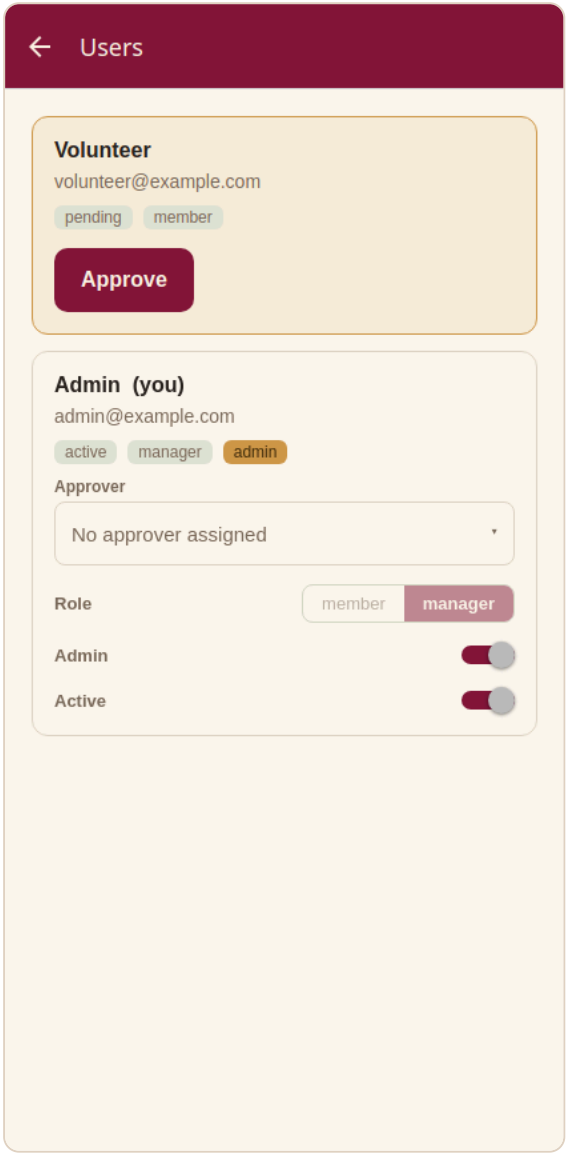
A note on timezones

Every entry remembers *where* it happened. Someone working 9:00–17:00 in Singapore shows 9:00–17:00 on the correct day for every viewer — reports never shift hours into the viewer's timezone.

Part 3 — For admins

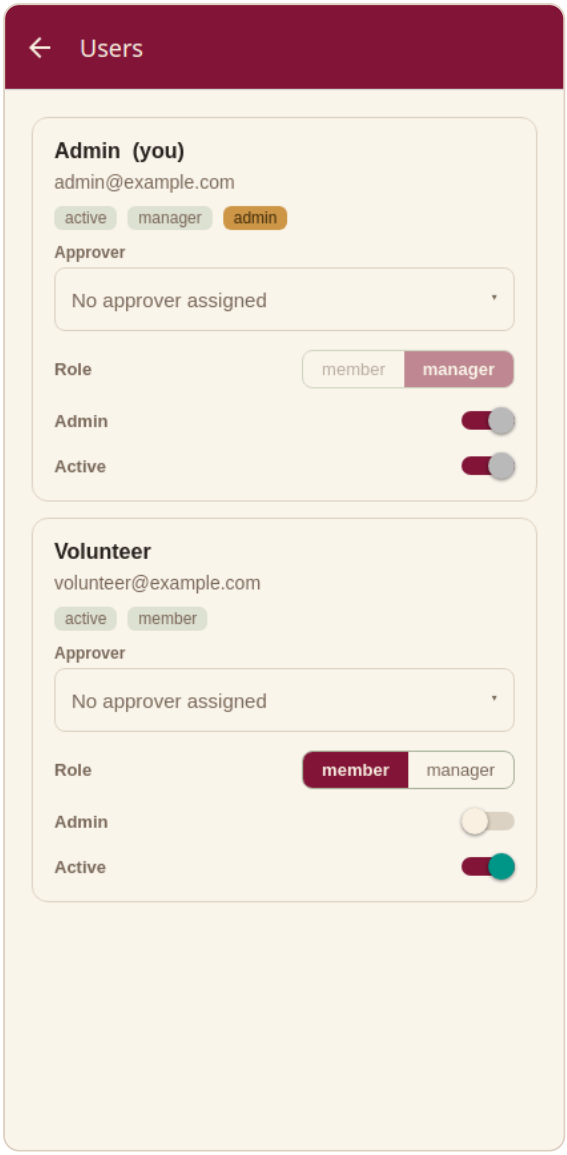
Admins manage people. On Home: **Manage users** (admins also see Approvals — an admin can approve or reject *any* submitted timesheet, including their own).

3.1 Approving new users



When someone signs in for the first time they appear in **Manage users** with a gold *pending* card showing their name and email — the Home button reads **“Manage users (1)”** while requests are waiting, and admins get a push notification. Tap **Approve** and their screen unlocks live, wherever they are.

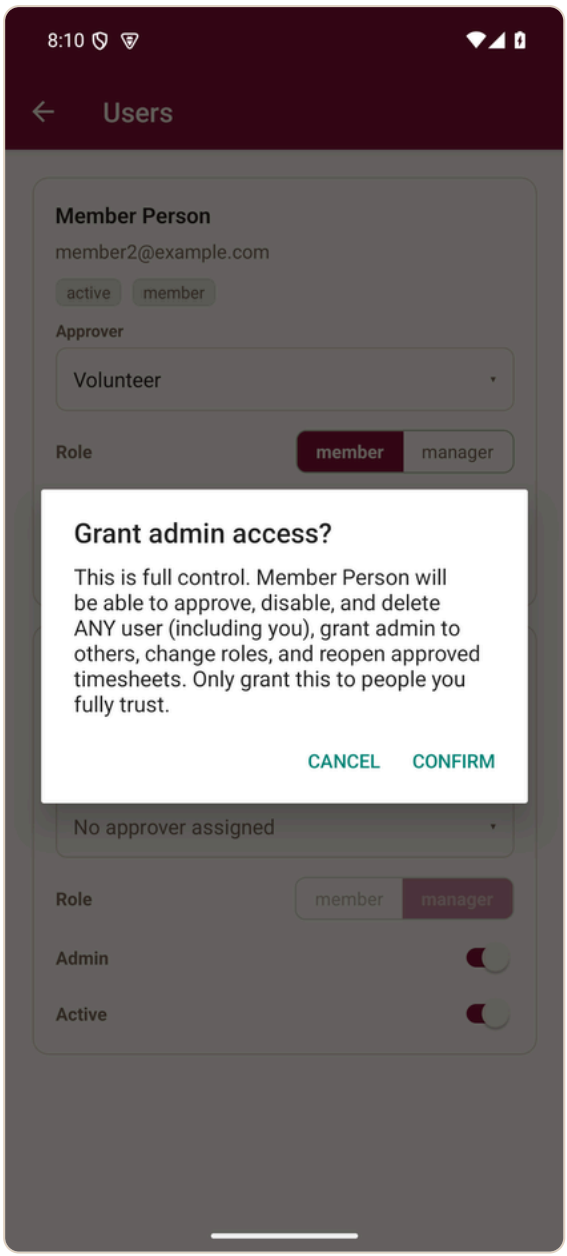
3.2 Managing a user



Each active user's card shows their state directly:

- **Approver** — who approves their timesheets. Set it here, or let them pick their own on their home screen. (Managers can set this for non-admins too.) A manager or admin may be listed as their own approver. Note that **changing someone's role, or disabling them, clears every approver pointing at them** — those people will be asked to pick a new approver before their next submission.
- **Role: member | manager** — managers get Approvals, Reports, and Activities.
- **Admin** — the full-control switch (see below).
- **Active** — turn off to disable an account: they're locked out immediately and can't log hours. Turn back on to restore. Nothing is ever deleted.

Every change asks for confirmation, so a stray tap can't promote or disable anyone. You cannot demote, disable, or un-admin **yourself** — so the organization can never lock itself out.



Grant admin sparingly. As the dialog says: an admin can approve, disable, and manage *any* user, grant admin to others, change roles, and reopen approved timesheets. Admin is different from manager — a manager runs the operation (activities, reports, approvals); an admin controls the people.

3.3 Reopening an approved timesheet

Approved weeks are locked for everyone — except that an admin can **reopen** one: open the person's week (Reports → person → View timesheets, or your own in My timesheet) and tap **Reopen (admin)**. The week returns to draft; the owner fixes it and it goes through submit →

approve again. Use it for genuine mistakes discovered after the fact.

3.4 Odds and ends

- **First admin** of the system is created once during deployment; every further admin is granted in-app with the Admin switch.
- **Error banner**: if a red “Live data error” bar ever appears at the top of a screen, the app couldn’t load live data (permissions or connectivity). It’s also reported automatically to the error dashboard — tell the developer, mentioning what you were doing.

Part 4 — “How do I…?” quick answers

…log the hours I worked right now? Home → pick the activity → Clock in → work → Clock out.

…log yesterday’s hours? Home → Add hours manually → date “Yesterday” → set times → Save hours.

…fix a wrong entry? Home → My timesheet → open the week → tap the entry → change → Save changes.

…delete an entry? Tap the entry, then **Delete entry**.

…submit my week? My timesheet → check the week → Submit timesheet. (Clock out first; pick an approver once if you haven’t.)

…submit a week I missed a while ago? My timesheet → ‹ back to its month, tap its week chip → Submit. Old weeks have no deadline. Empty weeks can be submitted as “(no hours)”.

…add more hours after I submitted? Withdraw submission (while it’s still awaiting approval) → add hours → Submit again. If it was already approved, ask an admin to reopen it.

…see why my timesheet was rejected, and fix it? Tap the red banner on Home → tap the rejected week → read the reason → fix entries → Resubmit timesheet.

…change who approves my timesheets? Home → My timesheet approver → pick someone else. Applies from your next submission.

…sign in with a different Google account? Sign out (bottom of Home) → Sign in with Google → the account chooser appears.

…use the phone app when it says “This account isn’t set up for the app yet”? Sign in once on the website (https://sabeel-institute-time-tracker.web.app) with the same account; that creates it. Then sign in on the phone.

…stop the weekly reminder without losing other notifications? Home → Notification settings → switch off **Weekly submit reminder**.

…approve or reject someone's week? *(managers)* Home → Approvals → tap the submission → Approve, or type a reason and Reject.

…add hours for someone who forgot? *(managers)* Approvals → their submission → "Add entry for {name}". Or before they submit: Reports → the person → View timesheets → Add entry.

…create a new activity? *(managers)* Home → Activities → name it → Add.

…get official hours for a grant report? *(managers)* Reports → set the period → keep "Official (approved only)" → Export CSV.

…print a volunteer's hours statement? *(managers, website)* Reports → tap the person → Print statement.

…let a new team member in? *(admins)* They sign in once with Google → Manage users → Approve on their pending card.

…make someone a manager / an admin? *(admins)* Manage users → their card → flip Role to manager, or the Admin switch → confirm the dialog.

…disable someone who left? *(admins)* Manage users → their card → Active switch off → confirm. Their history stays.

…fix an already-approved week? *(admins)* Open that week → Reopen (admin) → the owner fixes and resubmits.

Troubleshooting

What you see	What it means	What to do
“Almost there” screen after signing in	Your account awaits admin approval	Ask your admin; the screen unlocks by itself once approved
“Pick your timesheet approver…” when submitting	No approver chosen yet	Home → My timesheet approver → pick one
“This week’s timesheet is submitted/approved…” when clocking in	The current week is locked	Withdraw the submission (or ask an admin to reopen an approved week)
“Clock out before submitting this week”	A session is still running	Clock out, then submit
An entry is outlined red: “Overlaps another entry”	Two entries on that day have overlapping times	Tap one and fix its times; submission unlocks once no entries overlap
No push notifications arriving	Permission not granted on this device, or that kind is switched off	Allow notifications when the app asks (or in system settings), and check Home → Notification settings
Red “Live data error” bar	The app couldn’t load live data	Check connectivity; if it persists, tell the developer — it’s also auto-reported
A week chip has a red dot	That week was rejected	Tap the red banner on Home → fix → resubmit

Manual source: `docs/USER-MANUAL.md` (images in `docs/manual/img/`). PDF: `docs/USER-MANUAL.pdf`. Update both together when the app changes.